BTC 8-Hour Market Report

BTC ~ $84,400

Wednesday 21 Oct 2026, 23:52 Malaysia time (15:52 UTC)

Bitcoin.com/Bitstamp, Bitcoin Magazine: +2.5% 24h, +3% week

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral to mildly bullish	**Next 24h:** $82,800 - $85,800	**Key floor:** $82,000 - $82,300 (weekly max pain)	**Big event:** Weekly expiry Fri 23 Oct 4pm; FOMC 29 Oct 2am

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

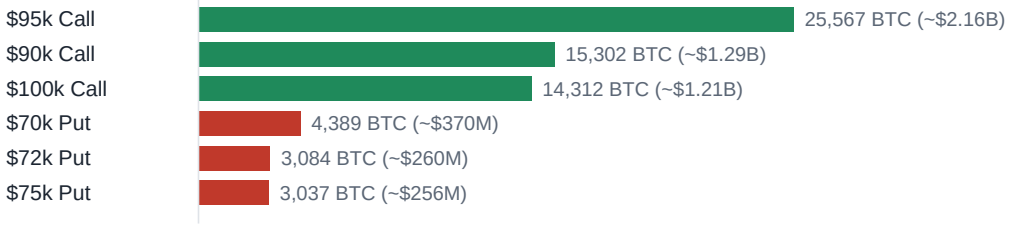
- **Next expiry:** daily Deribit options at **4:00pm MYT Thu 22 Oct** (08:00 UTC). Daily books are typically small; no published size was found this run.
- **Weekly (Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm MYT):** about 13,800-14,800 BTC (~$1.2B at today's price), put-heavy with P/C 1.24 and max pain $82,000; largest strike is the $78k put.
- **The expiry that matters:** the monthly on **Fri 30 Oct** (~148,600 BTC, ~$12.5B, P/C 0.50, max pain $78-79k). It lands two days after FOMC and is the main magnet for the coming week.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
Thu 22 Oct 4pm (daily)	n/a - not readable this run	Small (est.)	Too small to steer price on its own; spot flows dominate.
Fri 23 Oct 4pm (weekly)	$78,000 Put (largest strike)	Size not published; book ~$1.2B	Downside hedges cluster at $78-80k; max pain $82k sits ~2.8% below spot.
Fri 23 Oct 4pm (weekly)	$70k and $80k Puts (next largest)	Not published	Book leans to puts (P/C 1.24): traders are protecting, not chasing.
Fri 30 Oct 4pm (monthly)	$95,000 Call	25,567 BTC (~$2.16B)	Upside lottery tickets far above spot; little pull unless price runs to $90k+.
Fri 30 Oct 4pm (monthly)	$70,000 Put	4,389 BTC (~$370M)	Crash insurance; deep floor, not near-term.

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Thu 22 Oct, 4:00pm (daily)	n/a	n/a	n/a	Not available this run
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.15-1.25B	1.24	$82,000	Puts: $78k, $70k, $80k
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.5B (148,585 BTC)	0.50	$78,000-79,000	Calls: $95k 25,567 / $90k 15,302 / $100k 14,312; Puts: $70k 4,389 / $72k 3,084 / $75k 3,037
Fri 25 Dec, 4:00pm (quarterly)	n/a	n/a	n/a	Not checked this run

Monthly expiry Fri 30 Oct - largest open interest by strike (BTC, USD at $84.4k)



How options affect the market now

- **Next-24h expiry is too small to matter:** the Thursday daily will not move price; ETF flows, equities and oil headlines will.
- **Pull lower into Friday:** weekly max pain is $82,000, about $2,400 under spot. With spot rallying on short liquidations, some drift back toward $82-83k into Friday 4pm is the normal pattern if no new buyer appears.
- **Put skew = caution:** 25-delta puts trade richer than calls (Nov risk reversal about -3.2 vol). Traders pay for downside protection; a break of $82k could see dealers who are short those puts sell into weakness and speed the drop toward $80k

and $78k.

- **Upside is open, not walled:** the big call strikes ($90k, $95k, $100k) sit far above spot, so there is no options wall at $85k - the $84.5-85k ceiling is a spot/selling zone. A clean break could run to $86.5-87k quickly as shorts cover.
- **Cheap volatility:** DVOL ~38 (Oct 20), near 2026 lows, vs ~20-25% realized. Implied daily move ~2.0% (about +/-$1,700). Low IV ahead of FOMC often comes before a larger move.
- **Monthly gravity:** the ~$12.5B book on 30 Oct with max pain $78-79k is the bigger magnet after FOMC; expect volatility to pick up into that week.

Data note: the Deribit public API was not reachable this run, so options figures come from published reports (TokenPost 16 Oct for the weekly, CryptoTicker 17/20 Oct and Au79 21 Oct for the monthly). Strike sizes are 'largest seen' in those reports; USD sizes = OI x $84,400. Daily expiry data was not available.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC is around **$84,400** late on Wednesday, up about 2.5% in 24h, after an overnight dip to **$81,273** (below the 50-day average).
- The intraday high reached **~$84,740** (Bitstamp). The $84-85k band has repeatedly drawn selling in October and is being tested again.
- The rally was driven by short liquidations (~$188M of shorts in 24h), a tech-stock bid after SpaceX earnings and two days of strong ETF inflows.
- Moving averages: 20-day $83,117, 50-day $81,679, 100-day $74,780, 200-day $72,723. Price is back above the 20-day, so the short-term trend has improved.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$86,500 - 87,000	Next target if $85k breaks; the range top of the Oct swing.
Resistance 1	$84,700 - 85,200	Today's high and the October rejection zone; heavy spot selling.
Pivot	$83,100 - 83,400	20-day average and the prior breakout area; holding above keeps bulls in control.
Support 1	$82,000 - 82,300	Weekly max pain $82k and the recent pullback low.
Support 2	$81,300 - 81,700	Overnight low and the 50-day average.
Deep risk	$78,000 - 80,000	Round number, largest weekly put ($78k) and monthly max pain ($78-79k).

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
BTC perp open interest	$67.1B (Au79, 21 Oct)	High; leverage rebuilding as price rises.
Funding (8h)	+0.0079% avg; OKX +0.0034%	Mildly positive; longs not crowded.
Liquidations 24h	$243M total; $188M shorts; BTC $78M	Short squeeze fueled the move to $84k.
Spot BTC ETF flows	Oct 19 +$526.7M; Oct 20 ~+$23-30M	Best day since Sept, then slowed; Oct still roughly flat to negative.
Implied vol (DVOL)	~38.3 (Oct 20); realized 14d ~20%	Cheap options; daily implied move ~2.0%.
Options skew	25d RR about -3.2 vol (Nov)	Puts priced over calls: hedged market.
Fear & Greed	63 Greed (CMC-type); 44 Fear (Alternative.me)	Sources disagree; overall mid-range, not euphoric.

4. News and macro

- **Fed:** FOMC on 27-28 Oct with rates at 3.75-4.00%. Markets price ~81-88% hold and ~12-15% chance of a hike after hot inflation readings; a December hike is seen as likely. Chair Kevin Warsh is seen as a possible hawkish surprise.
- **Risk appetite:** SpaceX Q3 revenue of $14.6B (+161% y/y) and talk of a SpaceX-Tesla merger lifted tech; Meta, Tesla and IBM report Thursday after the US close.
- **Oil and geopolitics:** crude briefly topped $110 before easing on rumors of a US-Iran deal; Iran says indirect talks run via Pakistan and Qatar. US-Ukraine talks in Norway called productive.
- **ETFs:** spot BTC ETFs took in ~$550M over Oct 19-20, led by IBIT (+$665M on Monday); ETH ETFs have seen five straight outflow days.
- **Regulation:** SEC crypto framework consultation has closed; Utah sued Kalshi; Kazakhstan's AIFC court restricted several offshore exchanges. No major security incident reported.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Thu 22 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit daily options expiry
Thu 22 Oct, 8:30pm	US initial jobless claims
Fri 23 Oct, ~4:05am	Meta, Tesla, IBM earnings (after US close Thu)
Fri 23 Oct, 4:30am	Fed H.4.1 balance sheet
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly options expiry (max pain $82k)
Fri 23 Oct, 9:45pm / 10:00pm	US S&P Global PMIs / Michigan inflation expectations
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am	FOMC decision (press conference 2:30am)
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Monthly options expiry (~$12.5B, max pain $78-79k)
Fri 6 Nov, 9:30pm	US October nonfarm payrolls
Tue 10 Nov, 9:30pm	US October CPI

5. Summary and prediction

Bitcoin has bounced from $81.3k to about $84.4k on a short squeeze, a tech rally and strong ETF demand earlier in the week, and is now pressing the $84.7-85.2k ceiling that capped October. Options do not block the upside here (the big calls are at $90k+), but the weekly book is put-heavy with max pain at $82k, skew favors puts and implied volatility is near the year's lows ahead of FOMC on 29 Oct (MYT). That mix argues for range trading with a slight upward lean, and a fast move if either $85.2k or $82k breaks. **24h call: range $82,800-85,800, mild upside lean; a close above $85.2k opens $86.5-87k, a loss of $82.8k targets $81.3-82k.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range	50%	$82,800 - 85,500	Rejection near $85k, dip-buying above $83k; drift toward max pain into Friday.
Bullish breakout	25%	$85,200 - 87,500	Hourly close above $85.2k with more short liquidations and fresh ETF inflows.
Bearish fade	25%	$81,000 - 82,800	Loss of $82.8k, risk-off in tech after Meta/Tesla or an oil spike; puts at $80k/$78k in play.

- **Breakout signal:** hourly close above $85,200 with rising open interest and funding staying near neutral.
- **Breakdown signal:** hourly close below $82,800, then $82,000 (weekly max pain); oil back above $110 would add pressure.
- Next report: 7:50am MYT Thu 22 Oct

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